FINDING 2

As many as 395 lions, i.e. 44.2 per cent of the total, live outside forest areas

WHAT IT IMPLIES

Human-lion coexistence is hailed as a unique success story of Saurashtra, but incidents of conflicts are rising as lions venture beyond the forest boundaries—35 human deaths in 189 lion attacks since 2015

FINDING 3

For the first time, it has been reported that the big cats regularly move through the so-called 'lion corridors', which are not 'protected areas'

WHAT IT IMPLIES

This 'floating population' of 22 lions, the report claims, has a 'significant potential for future'. The identification of these corridors makes it imperative to prioritise conservation efforts over urban and industrial development

FINDING 4

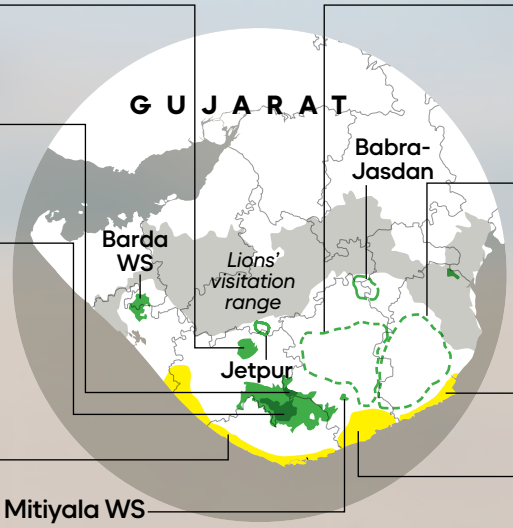
A new satellite population of 17 lions recorded in Barda Wildlife Sanctuary

WHAT IT IMPLIES

Barda near Porbandar is being touted as a 'second home' for the big cat, which could help in their genetic diversity. But biologists argue that the aerial distance of 50 km from the source population in Gir is too little to insulate the lions from disease outbreak or natural calamity

CAT SCAN IN GUJARAT

In 2020, Gir accounted for half the lion population. Now, it's down to 43% even as new satellite populations come up in three more districts



Girnar WS
● 56 ● 54
(↓4%)

Pania WS
● 10 ● 10
(0%)

Gir National Park & Sanctuary and adjoining areas
● 334 ● 384
(↑15%)

South Western Coast
● 20 ● 25
(↑25%)

Mitiyala WS
● 16 ● 32
(↑100%)

Savarkundla Liliya and adjoining areas
● 98 ● 125
(↑28%)

Bhavnagar mainland
● 56 ● 103
(↑84%)

Bhavnagar coast
● 17 ● 15
(↓12%)

South Eastern Coast
● 67 ● 94
(↑40%)

Lion population
● 2020 ● 2025 Change in ( )

SUB-ADULT
● 116 ● 140
(↑21%)

NEW SATELLITE POPULATION

Barda WS: **17**

Jetpur and adjoining areas: **6**

Babra-Jasdan and adjoining areas: **4**



WS: Wildlife Sanctuary

DISTRICT-WISE DISTRIBUTION

1. Junagadh	● 176 ● 191	(↑9%)
2. Gir Somnath	● 184 ● 222	(↑21%)
3. Amreli	● 233 ● 339	(↑45%)
4. Bhavnagar	● 81 ● 116	(↑43%)
5. Porbandar*	● 0 ● 16	
6. Rajkot*	● 0 ● 6	
7. Devbhoomi Dwarka*	● 0 ● 1	

*New habitats